Mail Rush: Roblox Game Design Doc

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Overview and core loop

Mail Rush is a Roblox game where you are a mail carrier. Every day you get a fresh route, deliver it as fast and cleanly as you can, earn one to three stars, and spend what you earn on a faster truck, better gear, and fun trinkets. The game is built around a one-day loop that takes about five to ten minutes to play.

1. **Clock in** at the Post Office. Grab your mail bag and load the truck.
2. **Get the route card.** It lists the stops, the special packages, the weather, and the par time.
3. **Drive and deliver.** Toss letters into mailboxes, set packages on porches, dodge dogs and roadblocks.
4. **Clock out.** Your time is graded one, two, or three stars. You get cash, stars, and a rank bump.
5. **Spend and sleep.** Buy upgrades, decorate your base, then sleep to start the next day.

Two currencies keep playing well and playing a lot as separate rewards:

Currency	Earned by	Spent on
Cash	Every delivery, bonuses, side requests	Vehicle parts, carrier gear, trinkets
Stars	Route grade (1 to 3 per day)	Unlocking districts and new vehicles

Star scoring

Every route has a par time, and your stars come from how you finish against it. Par is computed by the game, not hand-set, so it works for any generated route.

Stars	Condition	Reward
3	Finish under par	Full cash, 3 stars, a chance at a stamp
2	Finish under 1.5 times par	Full cash, 2 stars

Stars	Condition	Reward
1	Finish the route at all	Cash for delivered stops, 1 star
0	Quit or run out of daylight	Cash for delivered stops only

Par time formula, in seconds:

Par = 20 × number of stops + route length ÷ starter truck speed + weather bonus + event bonus

The route length is the driving distance between stops in order. The base speed is the starter truck, so par never assumes you own upgrades. Weather and events add a few seconds each so a rainy route is fair.

Small penalties and bonuses sit on top of the clock:

- Broken fragile package adds 15 seconds.
- Wrong house adds 10 seconds and you must go back.
- Clean mailbox swish from the truck subtracts 2 seconds.
- Perfect route with no penalties earns a gold stamp on the route card.

Stars are the only way to unlock districts and vehicles. A kid who grinds cash can buy a turbo, but only a three-star carrier opens the Mountain Pass.

Route generator

You hand-build one town once, and a script assembles a new route from it every day. One town of about 80 houses mixed across five levers gives thousands of distinct days, so nobody ever has to design routes by hand.

Every house in Roblox Studio gets tags through CollectionService. The generator reads those tags to pick stops.

Tag	Values	Used for
District	Maple Street, Downtown, Lakeside, Mountain Pass, Sky Harbor	Which houses are eligible today
MailboxType	Post, Slot, Gated, Apartment, Hill	Delivery difficulty and animation

Tag	Values	Used for
Difficulty	1 to 5	Scaling routes to the player's rank
HasDog	true or false	Dog spawn and the dog treat upgrade
PorchSpot	a named Part	Where packages get dropped

The five levers the generator mixes each day:

1. **Stop selection.** How many houses, which ones, and in what order. Starts at 6 stops and grows with rank up to 20.
2. **Package mix.** Letters, boxes, fragile items, frozen food on a melt timer, a live chicken that escapes if you brake hard.
3. **Conditions.** Clear, rain, fog, snow, or night. Each one changes handling, visibility, and par.
4. **Events.** Road construction closes a street, a parade blocks Downtown, a bridge is up, a loose dog patrols one yard.
5. **Special stops.** A resident request, a wrong-address package to redirect, a return-to-sender pickup.

The generator runs on the server at the start of each day:

1. Seed the random generator with today's date so every player gets the same route. Replays use a fresh seed.
2. Pick the district the player is working today, limited to districts they have unlocked.
3. Roll stop count from the player's rank, then pick that many tagged houses, weighted toward the Difficulty band for that rank.
4. Order the stops with a nearest-neighbor pass so the route makes sense to drive, then swap two stops at random so there is always a smarter order to discover.
5. Roll one condition and zero to two events from a weighted table that gets spicier at higher ranks.
6. Assign a package type to each stop. Fragile and timed packages are capped so a route never feels unfair.
7. Compute par from the result and hand the route card to the client.

Difficulty by rank keeps early days gentle and late days wild:

Rank	Stops	Conditions allowed	Max events	Special stops
Rookie	6 to 8	Clear only	0	0
Carrier	8 to 10	Clear, rain	1	0 to 1
Courier	10 to 13	Adds night	1	1
Express	13 to 16	Adds fog, snow	2	1 to 2
Postmaster and up	16 to 20	Anything	2	2

Two rules keep it fun: no two stops in a row at the same house, and a fragile package never spawns on the same day as the chicken until Express rank.

Districts

The map grows with the player. Each district adds new mailbox types, new vehicles that make sense there, and new tricks for the route generator, so a route in Lakeside never feels like a route in Maple Street.

District	Unlock cost	Feel	New mechanics	Signature vehicle
Maple Street	Free	Cozy suburb, wide streets	Post mailboxes, friendly dogs	Bike, then mail truck
Downtown	15 stars	Tall buildings, one-way streets	Apartment buzzers, parade events	Scooter for alleys
Lakeside	40 stars	Docks, islands, a drawbridge	Boat deliveries, bridge-up event	Mail boat
Mountain Pass	80 stars	Switchbacks, snow, cliffs	Snow handling, hill mailboxes, avalanche closes a road	Monster truck with plow
Sky Harbor	150 stars	Floating houses in the clouds	Air delivery, wind gusts, landing pads	Drone, then jetpack

Build Maple Street first and make it great. The other four can start as a single street each and grow over time. Every district needs a small Post Office branch so a day can start there without driving back across the map.

Delivery mechanics

Delivery should feel like a sport, not a chore. Three mechanics do the work: the mailbox toss, loose package physics, and mailbox variety.

The mailbox toss is the core skill. Hold to aim an arc, release to throw. You can throw from the truck window while rolling, and a clean swish plays a satisfying sound and subtracts 2 seconds. A miss means the letter lands in the yard and you have to hop out and grab it. Good players learn to drive the whole street without stopping.

Packages have physics. Boxes sit loose in the truck bed. Corner too fast and they slide. Slam the brakes and one bounces into the street. A fragile sticker means it breaks on a hard landing and costs time. This one mechanic makes driving fast feel risky in a fun way, and it makes the cargo straps upgrade feel amazing when you finally buy it.

Mailbox types give every stop a different rhythm:

Mailbox	What you do	Twist
Post	Toss from the road	The easy swish
Slot door	Walk to the door and push it in	Dog in the yard sometimes
Gated	Open the gate, then deliver	Gate swings closed on a timer
Apartment	Buzz the right unit in a lobby panel	Short memory minigame
Hill	Mailbox up a steep path	Sprinkler sweeps the path
Dock	Toss from the boat onto the pier	Waves move the target
Landing pad	Hover and drop	Wind gusts push you

Package types change what you carry:

- Letters are weightless and go in the toss bag.
- Boxes take truck space and must be set on the porch spot.
- Fragile boxes break on a hard drop or crash.
- Frozen food has a melt timer shown on the route card.

- The live chicken hops out of the bed if you brake hard. Chase it down.
- Mystery packages get opened by the resident on their porch for a surprise.

Upgrades

Upgrades come in three families. Vehicles are unlocked with stars, vehicle parts and carrier gear are bought with cash. Every upgrade should change how a route plays, not just a number.

Vehicle ladder. Each vehicle has a top speed, a cargo size, and a place where it shines.

Vehicle	Unlock	Cargo	Shines at
Bike	Start	4 letters, 1 box	Shortcuts through the park
Kick scooter	5 stars	6 letters, 1 box	Downtown alleys
Golf cart	10 stars	8 letters, 3 boxes	Quiet suburb days
Classic mail truck	20 stars	15 letters, 6 boxes	Everything, the workhorse
Delivery van	35 stars	20 letters, 12 boxes	Big Rush Day routes
Muscle car	50 stars	10 letters, 2 boxes	Speed runs with few boxes
Mail boat	Lakeside	15 letters, 6 boxes	Dock stops
Monster truck	90 stars	15 letters, 8 boxes	Snow and cliffs
Drone sidekick	120 stars	Carries 1 letter for you	Delivers one stop while you drive
Jetpack	200 stars	6 letters	Sky Harbor and showing off

Vehicle parts. Each part has three to five levels and costs more each time.

- Engine raises top speed.
- Tires add grip in rain and snow.
- Brakes stop you faster without launching packages.
- Turbo gives a boost with a cooldown.
- Cargo straps keep packages from sliding.
- Cargo rack adds box slots.
- Horn scares dogs away for a few seconds.

- Headlights widen your view on night routes.
- Snowplow clears drifts on the mountain.

Carrier gear upgrades the player instead of the car.

- Throwing arm increases toss range and accuracy.
- Running shoes speed up walking stops.
- Bigger bag holds more letters per trip.
- Dog treats turn chasing dogs into friends that follow you.
- Rain jacket cancels the rain slowdown.
- Sunglasses cut through fog.
- Coffee thermos gives one free turbo per day.

Trinkets, stamps and the home base

Trinkets are where the kids' creativity goes. They are cheap, plentiful, and purely for fun, so collecting becomes its own loop beside the star chase.

Trinket categories

- Dashboard pets: a bobblehead dog, a hula cat, a tiny gnome.
- Bumper stickers and paint jobs for every vehicle.
- Horn sounds: goose, trumpet, dial-up modem, a kid yelling "MAIL!"
- Hats and uniforms for the carrier.
- Mailbox skins for your own base mailbox.
- Trails and exhaust effects for the fast vehicles.

Stamps are the rare collectible. There are about 50 in the game and a stamp album in the base shows which ones you have found.

How you get one	Example
Perfect route with no penalties	Gold Route stamp
Hidden on the map	A stamp on the roof of the Downtown clock tower
Secret shortcut discovered	The Creek Jump stamp
Seasonal event	The Haunted Route stamp
First time using a new vehicle	The Maiden Voyage stamp

Your own post office is the home base you decorate. It starts as a shed and grows with rank.

Rank	Base	New room
Rookie	A shed with a bike rack	Nothing yet
Carrier	A small garage	Vehicle bay for one truck
Courier	A proper post office	Trinket wall and stamp album
Express	Two-story building	Sorting room with a conveyor minigame
Postmaster	A landmark with a clock tower	Trophy room and a photo wall
Legend	Gold-trimmed everything	A statue of your character out front

Friends who visit your base can see your trinket wall and stamp album, which is the real reason to collect.

Big fun ideas

These are the ideas that turn a solid delivery game into one kids talk about at school. Pick two or three for the first version and save the rest.

Dogs. Some yards have a dog that chases you from the gate to the mailbox. Early on it just slows you down. With the horn upgrade you scare it off, and with dog treats it becomes a friend that rides in your truck for the rest of the day. Every dog has a name on its collar.

Rush Day. Once a week the route is double size with double pay, more dogs, and a marching band moving through Downtown. It is the day you bring the van.

Resident requests. A resident runs out and asks for something on top of the route. "Get my birthday cake here before the candles melt." "My package went to the wrong house, can you grab it?" Timed side quests with bonus cash.

Mystery packages. The resident opens it on their porch while you watch. Sometimes it is a pizza, sometimes a jack-in-the-box, sometimes 50 rubber ducks.

Lost mail. A rival carrier's truck hits a bump and letters scatter across the park. Gather them for bonus cash and a thank-you note on your base wall.

Shortcuts. A creek jump, a gap in the fence, a path through the park that only a bike fits through. Finding these is the real speedrun skill and each one has a stamp.

Seasonal events.

Season	Event
Halloween	Haunted routes with ghost mailboxes that float away
Winter	Blizzard week with triple mail and a sled vehicle
Spring	Flower deliveries that wilt on a timer
April Fools	Every mailbox moves 10 feet when you look away
Summer	Ice cream truck rival you can race

Photo mode. A camera that snaps your truck mid-jump. Favorite shots go on the photo wall in your base.

The sorting room. Before a Rush Day you sort packages on a conveyor into the right truck bins. Fast sorting gives a head start on the clock.

Return to sender. One stop asks you to pick up a package and drop it back at the Post Office. It is heavy, so the truck handles differently until you unload it.

Multiplayer

Multiplayer should add friends without adding griefing. Nobody can block, steal, or crash anyone, and every mode uses the same daily seed so results are comparable.

Mode	How it works	Why kids will love it
Daily leaderboard	Same seed for everyone, best time per day shown at the Post Office	Beating a friend's time by 2 seconds
Co-op route	Two to four players split one big route and share the star grade	Siblings on one team
Rival race	Two players run the same route live, each sees the other as a ghost	Racing without collisions
Base visits	Walk into a friend's post office and see their trinket wall	Showing off the stamp album
Relay	Each player does one district, the baton is a package	Teams of four on Rush Day

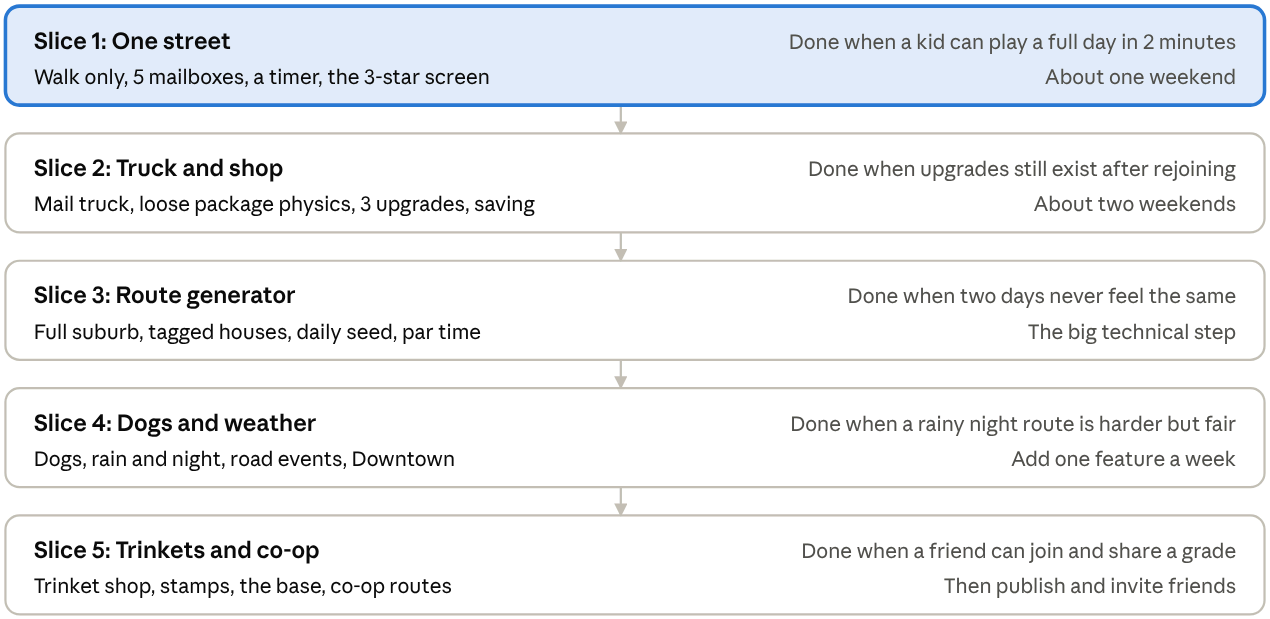
In co-op, the route card splits stops by color and each player's truck shows their color. The shared timer only stops when the last stop is done, so the fast kid has to help the slow kid.

Shared worlds show other players' trucks as ghosts with no collision. That one rule removes almost every way to grief.

Build plan

Build the game in five slices so the kids can play something real after the first weekend. Each slice is a complete game on its own, and nothing in a later slice is needed to enjoy an earlier one.

Every slice is a playable game, and the street comes before the truck



build plan · 5 playable slices, each with a done-when gate

Each band is one slice, the arrows are the order, and the right side says what finished looks like. Slice 1 is the whole game in miniature and should be built before anything else.

Tools you will use, all free:

- Roblox Studio for building the town and testing.
- Luau, the Roblox scripting language, for every script.
- CollectionService for tagging houses so the generator can find them.
- DataStoreService for saving cash, stars, upgrades, and stamps between sessions.
- The Roblox Creator Hub and Toolbox for free vehicle and house models to start from.

Scripts to write, in order: a day timer and star screen, a mailbox toss, a vehicle seat with cargo physics, a shop with DataStore saving, the route generator, and finally dogs, weather, and events as separate modules the generator can turn on.

Open questions

These decisions change how the plan gets built. Answer them as a family and the rest of the doc adjusts.

- [ ] How old are the kids, and have they used Roblox Studio or written any Luau? This decides whether the next step is a step-by-step build guide or a brief they implement themselves.
- [ ] Single-player first, or is playing with friends the point from day one? Multiplayer roughly doubles the work in slices 2 and 3.
- [ ] Does a day mean a real calendar day with one route per day, or an in-game day you can replay freely? Real days build habit and leaderboards. In-game days let kids grind upgrades in one sitting.
- [ ] Art style: blocky and bright, low-poly and cute, or cartoony realistic? This also sets how many houses fit in a weekend.
- [ ] Any interest in Robux monetization, or purely for fun? This changes whether some trinkets become game passes.
- [ ] Who is building? Just the kids, you with them, or should Claude write the actual Luau scripts for the generator and star system?
- [ ] What is the game actually called? Mail Rush is a placeholder and the kids should pick.